

First Congregational Church of Los Angeles
Pentecost 12
23 August 2026

COMMUNION

Organ Prelude-Concert

Chiming of the Hour

[ML & Lauren to center chancel]

Welcome

Words of Gathering

LS: May it be so.

May it be so for all of us!

ML: *Please stand now, in body or in spirit, for our Hymn of Gathering*

[Choir mics on for hymn leaders]

***Hymn Of Gathering**

[Michael center chancel]

Prayer of Awareness

May it be so for all of us.

Amen and Amen.

[All turn towards choir]

Introit

[Lauren to lectern]

***The Lord's Prayer**

Amen and Amen!

[All turn towards altar]

***Gloria Deo**

Glory be to God, and to the Christ and to the Holy Ghost,

As it was in the beginning, is now and ever shall be.
World without end, Amen, Amen.

[Michael center chancel]

***Passing of the Peace**

Please join me in these words of peace:

And also with you.

You are invited to share this ancient greeting with a bow

Please be seated

[Lauren to lectern]

Reading from Our Religious Tradition

Thanks be to God!

[Christoph transition ML to center chancel]

Prayers with the People

ML

Invitation to Silence and Prayer

[2 minutes Christoph transition out of silence]

Prayer of Our Hearts

Amen and Amen.

[Christoph transition for choir]

Meditation Anthem

[Christoph transition Laura to pulpit]

Sermon

[Christoph transition as Michael & Laura go behind communion table]

The Eucharist and Blessings

LVF & ML

Words of Invitation and Remembrance

Prayer of Blessing

Amen and Amen.

LVF: This table is for all, whether you have a lot of faith, etc....

Sharing of the Bread and the Cup

At this table we celebrate all the diverse ways we have been created. Everyone is invited to share in this feast. This morning we will receive communion with gluten free wafers and grape juice. You are invited to come forward to receive these gifts and then light a candle to signify the prayers of your heart on this day. As we share this time, we remember that this is the bread of new life and the cup of hope, given in love for each of us.

[Lauren to lectern]

Invitation to Generosity

Offertory

[All turn towards altar]

***Doxology**

From all that dwell below the skies,
let the Creator's praise arise!

Alleluia! Alleluia!

Your name shall sound and praises soar
till suns shall rise and set no more.

Alleluia! Alleluia!

Alleluia! Alleluia! Alleluia!

[adapt/Isaac Watts, 1719]

[Lauren to lectern]

***Prayer of Offering**

May it ever be so for all of us.

Amen and Amen.

Please be seated

[Michael & Laura center chancel]

Life at First Church

Words of Blessing

Amen! May it be so!

Choral Response

[Choir mics on for hymn leaders]

***Hymn for the Journey**

[Michael center chancel]

Postlude

Dr. Christoph Bull, *Organist-in-Residence*

Inside The Music